

Strider's Report - Girallon Unchained

Party: Ruby (me), Zea, Koté, Necro

Objective: Investigate reports of strange Girallons to the south.

Setting Out

I met up with Zea, Koté and... Necro.

He arrived wearing chains and a straight jacket while being escorted by several guards.

Starting from the Verge, we headed south towards a swamp known as **The Broken Slough**.

Not long after arriving, Necro decided to turn himself into a crocodile to investigate something deeper in the swamp.

Unfortunately, a strange plant creature decided crocodile was on the menu and wrapped him up. We dealt with it quickly and continued on without much trouble.

First Night

As the sun went down, we made camp.

The peaceful night lasted right up until three lightning spirits attacked our position.

They were surprisingly dangerous, but we managed to defeat them without anyone getting seriously hurt.

One day south of the Verge and things were already trying to kill us. Business as usual.

Frog Folk

The following day we continued south and came across a small village beneath the water.

A group of frog folk surfaced to speak with us. They pointed us towards the south-east, though they didn't tell us much else.

Koté decided to pray at a statue of their god.

Almost immediately she entered some sort of trance and simply... started walking.

Since she seemed determined and wasn't walking into any trees, we decided to follow her rather than interrupt whatever was happening. It eventually led us exactly where we needed to go.

The Rotting Mansion

As we approached our destination, we noticed Girallons watching us from the trees.

Oddly enough, they weren't hostile. Not immediately, anyway, we thought it might have had something to do with Koté's trance.

They silently guided us towards an old rotting mansion hidden deep within the swamp. Something about them felt wrong.

Their bodies looked decayed, and their movements were stiff and unnatural, almost like puppets. It reminded me of the undead owlbear we encountered before. I suspect this could be another creation of the Broken Dirge.

Inside the mansion we found the source. A massive Girallon.

Its eyes had been torn out, leaving it completely blind, yet it somehow still directed the others, it looked just like an undead owlbear I saw before. Even in death, an alpha seems capable of leading its troop.

The Alpha

The fight quickly became chaotic. Several Girallons rushed us at once. I managed to keep multiple of them occupied, giving the others room to fight.

Eventually I brought down the alpha. I severed one of its arms, and the holy fire from my Branding Smite completely blew up the wound where it had once been attached.

The remaining Girallons fell shortly after.

A Tunnel for Another Day

After the battle, we searched the mansion and discovered a tunnel leading deeper underground. There was only one problem. It was completely flooded.

The place gave all of us a very uneasy feeling, and with no clear way to safely explore it, we decided it was better to return another day better prepared.

I have a feeling whatever is hiding down there isn't finished with us yet.

Notes for Future Striders

- The Broken Slough contains aggressive plant creatures and lightning spirits.
- The frog folk living beneath the water were friendly and pointed us south-east.
- The Girallons appeared undead or otherwise controlled through necromancy.
- A blind alpha Girallon seemed capable of directing the others.
- A flooded tunnel beneath the mansion remains unexplored and should be investigated by a prepared party.